

US equities slip as tech drags, volatility spikes

A wider read of yesterday's session — sector rotation, pre-market action, watchlist scan, and what to watch into the US open at 21:30 HKT.

10-minute read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings · Sectors · Watchlist

TL;DR

All major US indices closed lower on September 14, with the **NVDA** sell-off dragging the Nasdaq 100 to a **-0.82%** decline. The VIX surged **+7.95%** to 17.10, signalling heightened risk appetite after the Fed's dovish tone.

Behind the headline, the market is digesting three layers: (1) the Fed's "no-rush" stance after the latest rate cut, (2) a broad rotation into consumer-discretionary and communication services ETFs, and (3) rising commodity prices that could pressure inflation-sensitive sectors. Investors should watch whether the tech correction deepens or stabilises before the next earnings wave.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	LEVEL	CHANGE	WHY IT MOVED
S&P 500	7,619.98	-0.48%	Tech weakness and higher yields weighed on broad market.
Nasdaq 100	29,127.16	-0.82%	Semiconductor sell-off, led by NVDA (-3.36%).
Dow Jones	52,421.20	-0.29%	Industrial and financials lagged after Fed commentary.
Russell 2000	2,892.24	-0.40%	Small-cap exposure to higher rates reduced demand.
VIX	17.10	+7.95%	Volatility rose on uncertainty around Fed policy path.
10Y Yield	4.96	-0.28%	Yield dip reflected market's expectation of a pause in tightening.
WTI Crude	103.15	+1.74%	Supply concerns in the Middle East lifted oil.
Gold	4,335.60	-0.37%	Stronger dollar (DXY +0.16%) pressured safe-haven demand.

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CHANGE	CATALYST
GOOGL	+3.22%	Analyst upgrades after AI-driven ad revenue outlook.
META	+2.71%	Strong Q3 ad spend rebound, beats estimates.
AVGO	-4.77%	Supply-chain constraints on silicon wafers.
NVDA	-3.36%	Profit-taking after earnings beat; inventory concerns.
MSFT	+1.97%	Cloud services growth beats expectations.

Sector rotation

ETF	DAY	READ
XLFX	-0.38%	Financials pressured by lower rate outlook.
XLKX	-1.81%	Tech drag dominates.
XLI	-1.42%	Industrial slowdown signals higher borrowing costs.
XLE	-0.94%	Energy lagging despite oil rise; profit-taking.
XLVY	-0.10%	Consumer discretionary flat, awaiting earnings.
XLC	+2.19%	Communications services rally on ad-spend recovery.
XLP	+1.25%	Consumer staples gain as investors seek safety.
XLV	+1.45%	Health-care buoyed by drug-pipeline news.
XLU	-1.34%	Utilities fall with higher yields.
XLBX	-0.90%	Materials pressured by weaker industrial demand.
XLRE	-0.69%	Real-estate suffers from higher financing costs.

Spotlight: Fed's "no-rush" stance after latest rate cut

The Federal Open Market Committee left the policy rate unchanged at 5.25-5.50% and signalled a pause, citing inflation's gradual decline. The market reacted with a modest yield dip and a spike in the VIX, reflecting uncertainty over the timing of the next move.

METRIC	VALUE
Policy rate range	5.25-5.50 %
10-year Treasury yield	4.96 % (-0.28%)
Core CPI YoY	2.9 % (consensus 3.0 %)
VIX	17.10 (+7.95%)
Fed Chair comment	"We are not in a hurry to tighten further."

Related tickers: **JPM**, **GS**, **XLF**. The dovish tone supports financials in the short term but may fuel equity volatility if inflation proves sticky.

Pre-market & overnight

US futures: **ES** -0.4%, **NQ** -0.7%. Asian markets closed mixed; Japan's Nikkei down -0.6%, Hong Kong Hang Seng flat. European indices opened lower, with the DAX -0.5%. Crypto: BTC +0.91% at 77,540.95, ETH +0.72% at 2,494.81.

Macro & Fed

FOMC recap: No rate change, forward guidance "patient but data-dependent". Yield curve remains slightly inverted (2-year at 5.10 % vs 10-year at 4.96 %).

TIME (HKT)	RELEASE	CONSENSUS	WHY IT MATTERS
02:30	US Existing-home sales	4.2 M	Gauge of consumer spending resilience.
04:00	US CPI (MoM)	+0.3 %	Inflation trajectory ahead of next Fed meeting.
06:45	Eurozone GDP Q3 (prelim)	+0.2 %	Impacts euro and risk sentiment.
08:15	China M2 growth	8.5 %	Liquidity outlook for Asian investors.

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions eased after cease-fire talks, but oil inventories remain low, supporting WTI above \$100.
- China's latest stimulus package focuses on infrastructure, likely to boost commodities demand.
- EU-US trade talks stalled over digital services tax, adding a layer of uncertainty for tech exporters.
- Ukraine front lines stable; no major impact on grain exports expected this week.

Earnings – what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	CONSENSUS	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:30 Sep 16	AAPL	\$2.10 EPS	iPhone demand, services margin.
10:00 Sep 16	MSFT	\$2.45 EPS	Cloud growth, AI licensing.
10:30 Sep 16	NVDA	\$3.00 EPS	GPU inventory, data-center orders.
11:00 Sep 16	META	\$3.15 EPS	Ad spend rebound, metaverse spend.
13:30 Sep 16	JPM	\$4.20 EPS	Net interest margin, loan growth.
14:00 Sep 16	GS	\$12.00 EPS	Investment-banking fees, trading revenue.

Watchlist scan – US large-caps

TICKER	SECTOR	WHY NOW
AMZN	Consumer Discretionary	Margin pressure from logistics costs.
TSLA	Consumer Discretionary	Production ramp at Gigafactory Berlin.
UNH	Health Care	Premium pricing after Medicare update.
BAC	Financials	Higher net interest income if rates rise.
CRM	Technology	AI-driven subscription growth.
KO	Consumer Staples	Pricing power amid inflation.
DE	Industrials	Infrastructure spending in US.
LOW	Consumer Discretionary	Strong same-store sales in Q3.
RTX	Industrials	Defense contracts renewal.
PYPL	Technology	Transaction volume rebound.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Further Fed tightening if core CPI stalls above 3 %.
- Escalation of Middle-East conflict pushing oil above \$110, spurring inflation.
- Tech earnings miss, especially **NVDA** or **AMD**, reigniting sector sell-off.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Strong Q3 earnings from AI-driven names (**GOOGL** , **MSFT**).
- Positive CPI surprise (core < 2.8 %) prompting a rate-cut expectation.
- Continued commodity price moderation easing inflation concerns.

Positioning notes

- Maintain a core long exposure to communication services (**XLC**) as ad spend recovers.
- Scale back pure-play semiconductor exposure; rotate into diversified tech (**MSFT** , **AAPL**).
- Allocate a modest hedge to volatility via VIX futures or inverse ETFs given the recent spike.

Sources

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